[1] Barbara is from a small town in California. Some months ago, she had a terrible argument with her parents. She read an advert in a magazine about becoming a movie actress in Hollywood and thought her dream would finally come true. She did not expect her parents to refuse. "If you were eighteen," **they** told her, "you could answer the advert, and you could go for an interview – or even a casting – and try your luck in Hollywood. But you're too young! You have to finish your studies first. You can't give up your studies now!"

[2] Determined to realize her dream, Barbara decided to run away from home. She hitch-hiked to Los Angeles where she expected to live with some friends who had left about a year before. But she was surprised to discover that her friends had no jobs and nowhere really decent to live in. She was also disappointed to know that she had no talent to become an actress according to the Hollywood casting committee. At first, she did part-time jobs; she was an extra in a war film last month, but there was no permanent job for people like her without qualifications.

[3] Barbara has been living in Los Angeles for six months now. She has been begging in the street and sleeping wherever she can - sometimes on park benches or in cheap hotels. She used to say Los Angeles is a wonderful place. Now she wonders how she could have thought such a thing. In fact, she hates **it**. "There's nothing interesting about it; the people are cold and indifferent, and the place is expensive and uninviting," she thought to herself.

[4] When Barbara reached a desperate point, she went to a local center for the homeless. She now thinks about returning home; she misses her parents very much. But she thinks that even if she asked them to return home, they would not take her back. Two months later, she saw her parents on a TV program about missing teenagers urging her to come back home. She knew then that she was still the dear little Barbara.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

BASE ALL YOUR ANSWERS ON THE TEXT

A. ARE THESE SENTENCES TRUE OR FALSE? JUSTIFY. (3 pts)

1. Barbara's parents did not want her to leave school.

……

2. Barbara took part in a film.

……

3. Barbara finds the people in Los Angeles friendly and kind.

……

B. ANSWER THESE QUESTIONS. (3pts)

1. How did Barbara know about the casting?

……

2. How did she get to Los Angeles?

……

3. What did she do when she felt desperate?

……

C. PUT THE FOLLOWING EVENTS IN THE CORRECT ORDER ACCORDING TO THE TEXT (2pts; 0.5 pt for each)

a. Barbara was not accepted in the casting.

b. Barbara had an argument with her parents.

c. She saw her parents on TV.

d. She had to beg for money in the street.

e. She went to Hollywood.

1. Barbara had an argument with her parents.

2. ……

3. ……

4. ……

5. ……

D. COMPLETE THE FOLLOWING SENTENCES. (2pts)

1. Although her parents refused to let her go to Los Angeles, Barbara …….

……

2. Barbara was not selected by the casting committee because …….

……

E. FIND IN THE TEXT WORDS THAT MEAN ALMOST THE SAME AS : (3 pts)

1. film (paragraph 1): ……

2. find out (paragraph 2): ……

3. fantastic (paragraph 3): ……

F. WHAT DO THE UNDERLINED WORDS IN THE TEXT REFER TO? (2 pts)

1. they: ……

2. it: ……

A. FILL IN THE BLANKS WITH THE APPROPRIATE PHRASAL VERBS. (3 pts)

look up - turn down - hand out - take off - take care - set up

1. Mrs. Baker couldn't find someone to ……..… of her grandmother during her absence.

2. Because of the heavy rain, the plane could not ……..…..

3. In my view, you shouldn't …… such a well-paid job.

B. REWRITE THE SENTENCES AS SUGGESTED. (4 pts)

1. "I will repair the computer," Harvey said.

Harvey promised……..

2. Rogers lost all his money in the lottery the other day.

He wishes…….

3. The Smiths didn't send their daughter to university as they couldn't pay for her studies.

Because…….

4. The students finished the school project in time.

The school project……

C. FILL IN EACH GAP WITH AN APPROPRIATE WORD FROM THE LIST. (3 pts)

1. "You ……..……break the law," the policeman told the motorist.

might not - mustn't - needn't

2. Tahar Benjelloun, …… got the Dublin Literary Award in 2004, is a Moroccan writer.

whose - whom - who

3. Laura doesn't really regret ……..…… the opportunity to marry.

miss - missing - missed

D. MATCH EACH STATEMENT WITH ITS APPROPRIATE FUNCTION. (4pts)

EXPRESSIONS	FUNCTIONS
1. "I'm sorry, I took your keys by mistake," he said.	a. concession
2. Nancy took up English lessons to increase her chances to get the job.	b. apology
3. "Would you like a cup of tea?" he asked me.	c. offering
4. Mr. Baker attended the meeting despite his sickness.	d. purpose

1. . . . . 2 . . . .. 3 . . . . . 4 . . . .

E. FILL IN EACH GAP WITH AN APPROPRIATE WORD FROM THE LIST. (1 pt; 0.5 pt each)

care - subject - gap - attention - access

1. Many people in the countryside now have ……..…… to water and electricity.

2. "Which school …… do you find most interesting?" Dad asked me.

WRITING (10 POINTS)

Some students leave school earlier for different reasons. Write an article for your school magazine stating some of these reasons and the effects of dropping out of school. (Approximately 200 words)

These cues may help you:

some reasons	some effects
school far from home no motivation to learn family problems ..... etc.	poor knowledge(languages, literacy skills,...) no proper education no good job in the future ..... etc.

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KEY AND MARKING SCALE

Accept any appropriate answer not mentioned in this key.

I. COMPREHENSION (15 POINTS)

Testees should not be penalised for spelling or grammar mistakes in the comprehension section.

TRUE / FALSE: (3 pts)

1. **True.** "You have to finish your studies first. You can't give up your studies now!" (paragraph 1)
2. **True.** "she was an extra in a war film last month" (paragraph 2)
3. **False.** "the people are cold and indifferent" (paragraph 3)

WH QUESTIONS: (3 pts)

1. She read an advert in a magazine.
2. She hitch-hiked.
3. She went to a local center for the homeless.

ORDERING EVENTS: (2 pts)

1. e. She went to Hollywood.
2. a. Barbara was not accepted in the casting.
3. d. She had to beg for money in the street.
4. c. She saw her parents on TV.

SENTENCE COMPLETION: (2 pts)

1. …ran away from home (and hitch-hiked to Los Angeles).
2. …she had no talent to become an actress.

RIGHT WORD MEANING: (3 pts) 1. movie 2. discover 3. wonderful

WORD REFERENCE: (2 pts) 1. Barbara's parents 2. Los Angeles

II. LANGUAGE (15 POINTS)

PHRASAL VERBS: (3 pts) 1. take care 2. take off 3. turn down

REWRITING SENTENCES: (4 pts)

1. Harvey promised **to repair the computer**.
2. He wishes **he hadn't lost all his money in the lottery the other day**.
3. Because **they couldn't pay for her studies, the Smiths didn't send their daughter to university**.
4. The school project **was finished in time (by the students)**.

GAP FILLING: (3 pts) 1. mustn't 2. who 3. missing

MATCHING: (4 pts) 1. b. apology 2. d. purpose 3. c. offering 4. a. concession

GAP FILLING: (1 pt) 1. access 2. subject

III. WRITING (10 POINTS; task 1: 4 pts; task 2: 6 pts)

The following criteria should be respected while scoring the writing tasks.

Scoring criteria	Task 1	Task 2
Relevance of content to the task	2 pts	3 pts
Appropriateness and variety of vocabulary	1 pt	2 pts
Grammar and mechanics	1 pt	1 pt

Model answers (any appropriate answer is accepted)

Writing: Some students leave school earlier for different reasons. Write an article for your school magazine stating some of these reasons and the effects of dropping out of school. (Approximately 200 words): Why Do Students Drop Out of School? Every year, many students leave school before finishing their studies. Why does this happen, and what are the consequences? There are several reasons. First, in some areas the school is far from home, and transport is difficult or expensive, so students give up. Second, some students have no motivation to learn because they find lessons boring or they fail their exams. Another reason is family problems, such as poverty, divorce or illness, which force young people to find a job. Dropping out of school has serious effects. First of all, students end up with poor knowledge: they are weak in languages and literacy skills. Consequently, they do not receive a proper education. In the end, it is very difficult for them to find a good job in the future, and they often work for low salaries. To conclude, dropping out is a real problem. Parents, teachers and the government should work together to help students stay in school and build a better future.